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Orvan sea grain loadings stuck near a third of normal

[P1] Grain loadings at Orvan Grain Port ran at 32 on the ministry index in November, the lowest monthly reading since the corridor agreement ended.

[P2] The index was 38 in October and 40 in September, according to the Realm Trade Ministry.

[P3] Ship operators report that the port strike which began on 14 September is still limiting berth use, though some berths are working.

[P4] "The sea route is not closed, but it is not reliable either," said Samir Tolle, a commodity trader in Ravik.

[P5] The November reading is the third monthly fall in a row and the weakest since the agreement ended. Port agents say the berth shortage, rather than a lack of grain, is holding loadings down. Grain is arriving at the port by road and rail, but the store is filling faster than ships can take it away. The ministry has not said when it expects the index to improve. Buyers in Midgard and Tolan are working through contracts month by month rather than committing to longer terms.

[P6] The ministry's return is watched by buyers because it is based on loadings rather than on ship arrivals. A cargo can be counted in one month and delivered in the next, so the index and the customs figures do not always match. The ministry says the two measures are not meant to be identical. It has not changed its method since the corridor ended.

[P7] Rail loadings through the Ravik Rail Link have risen, but traders say capacity is limited.